AFFIDAVIT

Affiant: Desmond Anthony Reid
Re: Marcia Evadne Whitfield, A# [A-NUMBER]
Form I-360 VAWA Self-Petition

I, Desmond Anthony Reid, being of legal age, state the following:

1. My name is Desmond Anthony Reid. I was born on October 21, 1981, in Spanish Town, St. Catherine, Jamaica. I am a naturalized United States citizen. I live at 72 Halsted Street, East Orange, New Jersey 07018. My telephone number is [PHONE].

2. I make this affidavit in support of the self-petition of my friend, Marcia Evadne Whitfield. Everything I state here is based on my own personal knowledge, except where I say that Marcia told me something.

3. I have known Marcia for about twenty years. We met as young adults at church in Spanish Town and became good friends. After she came to New Jersey in 2018, we reconnected, and she has been like family to me ever since.

4. I know Vernon Lloyd Lattimore because we worked together for several years as forklift operators at a distribution warehouse. We were friendly at work and sometimes got together on weekends.

5. I am the one who introduced Marcia and Vernon. I invited both of them to my birthday party on October 21, 2021, at my home in East Orange, and I introduced them to each other that evening. They talked for most of the night, and before long they were dating. At the time I thought Vernon was a good man and that they would be good for each other. I regret that now.

6. Over the following months I saw Marcia and Vernon together often. They came to my home together, and I saw them at gatherings with friends. Vernon told me more than once that he had found the woman he wanted to marry. Marcia was very happy, and I could see that she loved him.

7. I attended their wedding at East Orange City Hall on July 15, 2022, and the dinner afterward. After the wedding, Marcia moved into Vernon's apartment on Prospect Street in East Orange. I visited them there several times, including for Thanksgiving dinner in November 2022. They lived there together as husband and wife.

8. I have no doubt that Marcia married Vernon because she loved him. She talked about buying a house and starting a life with him. She never gave me any reason to think she married him for immigration papers.

9. I left the warehouse in 2023 for a job closer to home, so I saw Vernon less often after that. In March 2024, Marcia called me upset and told me that Vernon had been fired from the warehouse in February and had hidden it from her for weeks, leaving the house every morning as if he was going to work. I was very surprised that he would keep something like that from his wife.

10. After their wedding, I personally never saw Vernon hit Marcia or argue with her. When I was around them, things seemed normal. However, during 2024 I noticed that Marcia changed. She

stopped coming to church, she did not return my calls as often, and when I did see her she seemed quiet, tired, and sad. She was not the cheerful person I had known for most of my life.

11. In 2025, Marcia told me what had been happening at home. She told me that Vernon stopped working and made her pay all the bills, that he yelled at her and called her terrible names, that he took money from their account, and that he spat on her during an argument. She also told me that he refused to go to her immigration interview and later moved out. She cried while telling me these things. I have known Marcia for twenty years, and I have never known her to lie. I believe her.

12. After Vernon moved out, I tried to call him to talk to him about how he treated Marcia, but he did not answer my calls.

13. Marcia is an honest, hardworking, and kind person. I respectfully ask that her petition be approved.

I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the United States of America that the foregoing is true and correct.

Signature: _____

Printed Name: Desmond Anthony Reid

Date: 10/18/2025

Place: East Orange, NJ